

Tester's Guide & Walkthrough

Everything your team needs to log in, explore each role, and try the AI résumé-to-job matching. Built for the University of Cebu — Lapu-Lapu & Mandaue graduate employability platform.

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GETTING SET UP

Run with Docker

GradConnect ships as a self-contained Docker stack, so you don't need to install PHP, Node, or PostgreSQL — only **Docker Desktop**. The whole app (web server, database, and background worker) starts with a single command.

1 • Install Docker Desktop

Download and install [Docker Desktop](#) for your operating system, launch it, and wait until the whale icon is steady (the engine is running). On Windows, keep the **WSL 2** option enabled if prompted, and let it finish its first-time setup before continuing.

2 · Get the project & start it

Open a terminal (PowerShell on Windows) and run these four commands:

```
git clone https://github.com/hernanpanaguiton-glitch/gradconnect.git
cd gradconnect
cp .env.docker.example .env.docker
docker compose up --build
```

Copy

The first build takes a few minutes — it downloads the images and compiles the front-end. It's ready when the log shows `Server running on [http://0.0.0.0:8000]`.

3 · Open the app

Visit <http://localhost:8000> in your browser and sign in with one of the accounts in the next section.

Registering your own account

The sign-up form now asks for a role.

Student

and

Alumni

accounts are activated right away but must confirm a *verification email* — open the mail inbox at <http://localhost:8025> to find it and click the link.

Alumni Officer

,

Dean

,

Industry Partner

, and

Student Affairs Office

accounts are held for *admin approval*: sign in as the Admin below and set the account to *active* on the Users page before it can log in. Admins are notified in-app and by email when a new account needs approval.

First launch sets everything up for you

Database migrations run and demo data (accounts, jobs, surveys, and the alumni@ résumé with its AI matches) is seeded automatically on the first boot. The background

queue worker runs as its own container

, so résumé uploads and the *Refresh* buttons process live — no extra commands needed.

Enabling live AI matching (optional)

The alumni@ account already shows pre-generated AI recommendations you can view immediately. To score *new* résumé uploads or the *Refresh recommendations* / *Refresh matches* buttons, paste the shared Gemini & Groq keys into `.env.docker` (GEMINI_API_KEY, GROQ_API_KEY), then restart: `docker compose down` then `docker compose up`. Without keys, uploads still save but stay unscored.

Handy commands

```
docker compose up -d          # run in the background
docker compose logs -f app    # watch the app logs
docker compose down           # stop the app (keeps your data)
docker compose down -v        # stop and wipe data for a clean restart
```

[Copy](#)

Stuck on a seeding / "duplicate key" error?

That means a previous run left half-seeded data. Reset with `docker compose down -v` (the `-v` wipes the database), then `docker compose up --build` for a clean start.

SIGN IN

Login accounts

Every demo account uses the password `password`. Pick the role you want to test. (New self-registrations start with no role assigned, so use these instead

— an Admin can grant roles afterward.)

ROLE	EMAIL	PASSWORD
● Alumni	alumni@gradconnect.edu.ph	password
● Student	student@gradconnect.edu.ph	password
● Industry Partner	partner@gradconnect.edu.ph	password
● Alumni Affairs	alumni.affairs@gradconnect.edu.ph	password
● Department Head	depthead.ccs@gradconnect.edu.ph	password
● Student Affairs	sao@gradconnect.edu.ph	password
● Admin	admin@gradconnect.edu.ph	password

Hitting a 419 / "Page Expired" on login?

Open the site in a fresh private/incognito window (or clear cookies for the site) and use the exact address above. That resets the session token.

● Alumni alumni@gradconnect.edu.ph

Alumni

A graduate managing their career profile, résumés, job applications, and AI recommendations. This is the best account to see the AI matching in action.

What you can do

- **My Profile** — fill in career details across four tabs: Basic Info, Education, Employment, Skills.
- **My Résumés** — upload a PDF résumé (this is what gets matched to jobs).
- **Job Board** — browse open positions, filter, and apply.

○ **Recommendations** — see jobs ranked by AI fit score with explanations and skill gaps.

○ **Surveys** — answer open employability & tracer surveys.

What to enter — Profile tabs

TAB / FIELD	EXAMPLE VALUE
Basic Info · Program	BS Information Technology
Headline	Backend Developer
Summary	Laravel developer with 4 years building REST APIs.
Employment status	Employed / Unemployed / Self-employed / Further study
City · Phone · LinkedIn	Cebu City · 0917... · linkedin.com/in/...
Willing to relocate	checkbox
Education	Institution, Degree, Field of study, Start/End <i>year</i> (e.g. 2018–2022), Honors
Employment	Company, Job title, Type (Full-time...), Start/End <i>date</i> , or tick "Currently working here"
Skills	Pick from the library, or type your own — an AI autocomplete suggests and validates real skills (e.g. PHP, Laravel, React, Kubernetes). Made-up entries are rejected.

Try the AI matching

○ Open **Recommendations** — `alumni@` already shows 6 ranked jobs (Backend Developer and Software Engineer score highest for its backend résumé).

○ Each card shows a **fit bar**, the model's **explanation**, and green "matched" / amber "gap" skill

chips.

- Upload your own résumé under **My Résumés** (see the samples below), then press **Refresh recommendations** to generate a fresh ranking.

Résumés can be PDF, DOCX, or TXT

(max 10 MB). Other formats are rejected. New uploads only get scored while the host's queue worker is running.

● **Student** student@gradconnect.edu.ph

Graduating Student

A soon-to-graduate student building a career profile and browsing internships & entry-level roles.

What you can do

- **My Profile** — same profile tabs as Alumni; set an *expected* graduation year.
- **Jobs & Internships** — browse and apply to open positions.
- **Recommendations** — AI job matches once a résumé is uploaded.
- **Surveys** — respond to open surveys.

Tip: build the profile, add a few skills, then upload a résumé to see recommendations populate (queue worker required for new uploads).

● **Industry Partner** partner@gradconnect.edu.ph

Industry Partner

An employer posting vacancies, reviewing applicants, and seeing AI-ranked candidates.

What you can do

- **My Company** — edit the company profile.

- **Job Postings** — create, edit, and close postings.
- **Candidates** — review who applied and update their status.
- **Matches** — see graduates AI-ranked against a posting.

What to enter — new Job Posting

FIELD	EXAMPLE VALUE
Title *	Backend Developer
Description *	Build and maintain REST APIs with Laravel...
Responsibilities / Qualifications	free text
Employment type	Full-time / Part-time / Contract / Internship
Location · Remote	Cebu City · remote toggle
Salary range	45000–70000 (shown as ₱45,000–70,000 / month)
Experience level · Min education	Mid · Bachelor
Status	Open (so it shows on the Job Board)
Application deadline	optional date — the last day to apply
Skills	add skills and tick which are <i>required</i>

After saving, open a posting's **Matches** and press **Refresh matches** to rank applicants by AI fit (queue worker required).

● **Alumni Affairs** `alumni.affairs@gradconnect.edu.ph`

Alumni Affairs Office

Runs employability & tracer surveys and views employment reports.

What you can do

- **Surveys** — create, edit, open/close, and view results.
- **Employability Report** — graduate counts and employment-status breakdown.

What to enter — new Survey

FIELD	EXAMPLE VALUE
Title *	Graduate Employability Survey 2026
Type	Employability / Tracer / Custom
Status	Open (so respondents can answer)
Question prompt	What is your current employment status?
Question type	text, textarea, single choice, multi choice, rating, boolean, number
Options	for choice types: Employed, Unemployed, Self-employed...
Required	toggle per question

Two surveys are already seeded and **open**, so the Alumni/Student accounts can answer them right away.

● **Department Head** `depthead.ccs@gradconnect.edu.ph`

Department Head

Read-only analytics scoped to their department (College of Computer Studies and its programs).

What you can do

- **Dashboard** — graduates in the department, employment rate, course-related employment.
- **Employability Report** — the same employment breakdown view.

No data entry — this role reviews figures only.

Student Affairs Office

Supports current students — records, scholarships, events, clearance, and student analytics.

What you can do

- **Dashboard** — student headcount, scholarship recipients, clearance progress, and event stats.
- **Student Records** — search the student/graduate directory and open a read-only profile (with résumés).
- **Scholarships** — scholarship programs, recipients, and budgets.
- **Student Events** — career fairs, workshops, and campus events.
- **Clearance & Records** — graduation clearance progress across offices.
- **Student Analytics** — the employability report view.

Registering as SAO

New Student Affairs accounts (like Alumni Officer, Dean, and Industry Partner) are held for *admin approval* before they can sign in. Use the seeded `sao@` login above to explore right away.

Administrator

Manages user accounts and the dynamic roles & permissions system.

What you can do

- **User Management** — search users; edit a user's *status* (active / suspended / pending) and assigned *roles*; delete users.
- **Roles & Permissions** — create custom roles and toggle each permission on a matrix. Core roles are protected from deletion.

Good test: dynamic permissions

Create a role, give it a permission, assign it to a user — that user's available menu and pages change accordingly. Suspend a user and they're blocked at login.

FEED THE MATCHER

Sample résumés to upload

The app accepts **PDF, DOCX, or TXT** (max 10 MB). Copy any résumé below into Google Docs or Word, then *Export / Save as PDF or DOCX* (or paste into a plain `.txt` file) and upload it under an Alumni or Student account's **My Résumés**. Each one is written to match different seeded jobs, so the AI rankings come out clearly different.

① Backend developer → matches "Backend Developer" / "Software Engineer"

Maria Reyes – Backend Software Developer

Copy

Backend developer with 4 years building web applications and RESTful APIs using PHP and the Laravel framework. Strong in MySQL and PostgreSQL database design and query optimization, Git version control, and Docker-based deployments. Built and maintained REST APIs serving web and mobile clients.

Bachelor of Science in Information Technology, University of Cebu.

Skills: PHP, Laravel, MySQL, PostgreSQL, REST API, Git, Docker, JavaScript.

② Frontend developer → matches "Frontend Developer" / "Full Stack Developer"

Noah Cruz – Frontend Developer

Copy

Frontend developer specializing in building responsive, accessible user interfaces with React and TypeScript. Experienced with modern CSS and Tailwind CSS, component-driven design, and integrating REST APIs. Comfortable collaborating in Git-based teams.

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, University of Cebu.

Skills: JavaScript, TypeScript, React, Tailwind CSS, HTML, CSS, REST API, Git.

③ Data analyst → matches "Data Analyst"

Liza Gomez – Data Analyst

Copy

Data analyst with experience turning raw datasets into dashboards and reports. Strong SQL and Python skills, comfortable with data cleaning, analysis, and visualization to support decision-making.

Bachelor of Science in Information Technology, University of Cebu.

Skills: Python, SQL, Data Analysis, Communication, Problem Solving.

What to expect

After uploading and (host-side) the queue processing it, open

Recommendations

: the matching role should sit at the top with a high fit score and a written explanation, while unrelated roles score low.

SET EXPECTATIONS

Known gaps — not bugs

This build covers the foundation plus the AI matching feature. A few menu items are intentional placeholders for future work — please don't log these as defects:

- Sidebar links that do nothing yet: [Career Resources](#), [Talent Search](#), [Job Moderation](#), [System Reports](#), [Settings](#), [Alumni Records](#), [Career Activities](#), [Graduate Profiles](#).
- The Employability Report is a basic summary (totals and status breakdown), not a full analytics suite.

- Dashboard numbers reflect current data — AI match counts climb only after résumés are uploaded and scored.
- Self-registration creates an account with no role; an Admin assigns roles afterward. For testing, use the seeded logins above.

Found a real issue? Note the **role**, the **page**, and what you **expected vs. saw** — that's enough to reproduce it quickly.

GradConnect — Graduate Employability & Career Development Platform · University of Cebu, Lapu-Lapu & Mandaue